



BETWEEN OCTOBER 2023

and September 2024, the BSE Sensex—the stock market's barometer—jumped 28%, climbing from the 65,828-mark in September 29, 2023 to an impressive 84,300 on September 30, 2024. This upswing in the 30-share BSE Sensex wasn't just numbers on a chart; it also represented massive wealth creation. But the markets have been in a correction mode since then.

Nearly ₹102 lakh crore was added to the market capitalisation (m-cap) of the BT500 companies, bringing their total valuation to a staggering ₹363 lakh crore. To put that in perspective, the Union government had proposed a budget of ₹100 lakh crore for infrastructure over five years in 2019-20—a figure this surge in m-cap has matched in just 12 months. And the Top 4 companies on the BT500 list—Reliance Industries Ltd, TCS, and HDFC Bank, respectively—have retained their ranks from 2023.

What's striking is this year's growth—the strongest in three years. Last year, the m-cap of the BT500 companies inched up 4%, while the rise was 26% in 2022. This time, investors bought on every fall, despite a tough economic situation. In fact, there was no impact on the stock price of foreign investors or Indian promoters selling equity to raise more funds via the QIP route. While a K-shaped economic recovery is a reality, company sales in the first half of FY25 hint at some pain. Plus, geopolitical tensions are shifting from Russia-Ukraine to the Middle East. Let us take a closer look at how these factors are reshaping the landscape.

DIGITAL POWER AND RURAL REACH

The overall trend among the BT500 companies shows that many FMCG firms have struggled to maintain or improve their ranking in 2024.

THE M-CAP GIANTS

➤ Top 10 companies in terms of average m-cap

➤ Six companies in the Top 10 retain their rank from last year

Rank			Average Market Capitalisation (₹ crore)		
2024	2023	Company	Oct '23-Sep '24	Oct '22-Sep '23	Growth in %
1	1	Reliance Industries	18,89,480	16,74,550	12.8
2	2	Tata Consultancy Services	14,23,413	12,13,956	17.3
3	3	HDFC Bank	11,84,856	9,68,605	22.3
4	4	ICICI Bank	7,64,289	6,39,027	19.6
5	9	Bharti Airtel	7,53,216	4,89,930	53.7
6	6	Infosys	6,62,258	5,99,162	10.5
7	7	State Bank of India	6,53,744	5,11,869	27.7
8	5	Hindustan Unilever	5,92,467	6,04,858	(2.0)
9	11	Life Insurance Corporation of India	5,83,705	3,94,836	47.8
10	8	ITC	5,61,885	4,93,804	13.8

NOTE FIGURES IN BRACKETS SHOW DECLINE

THE GROWTH CHART

➤ Top 10 companies in terms of profit after tax

➤ Bharat Petroleum and Tata Motors showed the highest growth

PAT Rank		Profit after Tax (₹ crore)		
2024	Company	2023-24	2022-23	Growth in %
1	Reliance Industries	79,020	73,670	7.3
2	Oil & Natural Gas Corporation	57,101	34,046	67.7
3	Tata Consultancy Services	46,099	42,303	9.0
4	Indian Oil Corporation	43,161	11,704	268.8
5	Coal India	37,369	31,723	17.8
6	Tata Motors	31,807	2,690	1,082.5
7	Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd	26,859	2,131	1,160.4
8	Infosys	26,248	24,108	8.9
9	NTPC	21,332	17,121	24.6
10	Adani Power	20,829	10,727	94.2

SOURCE BT500, ACE EQUITY